

CALCUTTA TO CAMBRIDGE TO CONGRESS

Bose was accused of beating up a British professor and expelled from Presidency College in 1916. He subsequently went to Cambridge to take the Indian Civil Services exam. Despite having only a few months to prepare, he achieved a high rank. But the brilliant young man resigned from the prestigious appointment he received because he could not bring himself to serve the British Raj. Upon his return to India in 1921, Bose joined the Congress and participated in the non-cooperation movement, organizing protests and writing articles critical of the British.

Freedom for everyone

In the late 1920s and the 1930s, the British arrested Bose and jailed him several times. During one stint in jail, his health grew so poor that the government offered to send him to Europe to recover, so long as he did not return to India. During this period, he came to believe that India needed modernization, industrialization and a strong military, and that socialism could change society for the better. Crucially, he did not agree with Gandhi's non-violent approach, as he felt that it was too slow and ineffective.

Uneasy allies

In 1939, World War II broke out in Europe, with Britain fighting Germany, Italy and Japan. Bose thought Britain's enemies could be India's friends. So he disguised himself and made a daring escape out of India. He travelled to